



The Grass Club

In markets that are determined more by swings than strategy, Ajay Srinivasan, Head of Financial Services at Aditya Birla Group is trying to ride the storm. The fiscal mess, poor foreign investor sentiment and stagnant reforms are all adding to his woes. But when in doubt, Ajay heads to the golf course and focuses on his game rather than worrying about things he can't control. He speaks to Shaili Chopra on Tee Time on why he's optimistic that India's phoenix will rise from the ashes.

To date, what is your proudest golf accomplishment?

Hole-in-one at the 13th hole at Willingdon.

What is your biggest golf pet peeve on or off the course?

Slow play caused by people spending inordinate amounts of time studying greens and practicing shots that go horribly wrong.

What is your favorite golf destination?

My favourites would probably be Bali and Bintan.

Dream foursome?

Rory, Phil Mickelson, Kapil Dev and me.

What's your business motto?

Think Big, Think Different.

What does leadership mean to you?

Leadership is an opportunity to make an impact on the lives of many, tempered by the realisation that this opportunity comes with a lot of responsibility and need for humility.

How has golf improved your leadership capabilities?

Perhaps the most important thing I have learned from golf is that small, continuous improvements lead to big changes in results.

Tell us how the markets are headed from here

Valuations look attractive relative to history but a lot

depends on the external situation and our own macro situation. I would like to think markets are close to the bottom barring any major calamitous development.

How do you use golf in your work life?

It's often a great way to meet people and build relationships. In my stint in Asia, I found this the one way to make up for the fact that I don't drink or eat meat.

What has golf taught you about doing business?

Focus on your own game rather than worrying about things you can't control, make small improvements continuously, have patience and play fair.

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Who's your golf buddy?
Kapil Dev and me.

What's your golf motto?

Be patient.

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Watch



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Saturday 11 pm ;

Sunday 9 am & 10 pm

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must have raised the prestige of the drink.
Champagne was earlier seen as a bit ex-